
netcheck

Release 1.8.0

Gene C

Oct 13, 2025

CONTENTS:

1	netcheck	1
1.1	Overview	1
1.2	Key features	1
1.3	New / Interesting	1
1.4	Getting Started	1
1.5	Options	2
2	Appendix	5
2.1	Installation	5
2.2	Dependencies	5
2.3	Philosophy	6
2.4	License	6
3	License	7

NETCHECK

1.1 Overview

netcheck : Check network connectivity

1.2 Key features

- netcheck uses ping to check network status of host and/or /ips
- Data is saved to file(s)
- netcheck-plot can be used to plot the saved data.

1.3 New / Interesting

Initial Commit

1.4 Getting Started

netcheck is designed to be run periodically, saving results to files from which netcheck-plot can be used to create plots showing packet loss over time.

By default netcheck is silent unless there is packet loss. This is convenient when run from cron.

Using the `-v` option allows it to show output even when no packet loss is seen.

For example you may want to run this command from cron, perhaps every 15 minutes:

```
netcheck -d /opt/netcheck 1.1.1.1 8.8.8.8
```

it will report nothing unless both remote hosts have some packet loss. Since occasional packet drops are not uncommon, its good to have 2 or more hosts for the check. You can use `-any` option to have it report if any host has some packet loss.

If no hosts are provided, then default hosts are `1.1.1.1` and `8.8.8.8`.

Using the `-d <dir>` option has packet loss data saved into files under the specified directory. With the above command observed packet losses will be saved to 4 files:

```
ncheck-1.1.1.1
ncheck-8.8.8.8
ncheck-merged.any
ncheck-merged.all
```

One file for each host and the *ncheck-merged.any* records packet seen by any host and *ncheck-merged.all* has the data when all hosts had packet loss seen at the same time.

The *-I*, *--Interface* option can be used to specify which network interface the check is to be run from. Not to be confused with the *-i*, *--interval* which specifies the interval used between each ping packet.

To generate a plot for any of the files simply run:

```
netcheck-plot -f /opt/netcheck/ncheck-merged.all
```

which by default will create the pdf file

```
./pdf/ncheck-merged.all.pdf
```

For all available options please see *--help* for either application.

1.4.1 How It Works

Netcheck runs ping in parallel on each host listed using asyncio. By default 100 packets are sent to each host, though this can be changed using the *--num* option.

1.5 Options

Available options from *--help*:

netcheck:

```
positional arguments:
  hosts                host(s) comma separated if more than one (None)

options:
  -h, --help            show this help message and exit
  -a, --any             Report error if any host has loss instead of all hosts (False)
  -b, --base BASE       base name for output (ncheck)
  -d, --dir DIR         directory to save output ( )
  -i, --interval INTERVAL
                        ping interval (0.25)
  -I, --Interface INTERFACE
                        ping interface or IP address to use as source ( )
  -4, --ip4-only        Use IPv4 only (False)
  -6, --ip6-only        Use IPv6 only (False)
  -n, --num NUM         num pings (100)
  -np, --no_parallel    No parallel (False)
  -t, --test            test mode - generate fake lost packets(False)
  -v, --verb            verbose mode (False)
```

netcheck-plot:

```
options:
  -h, --help            show this help message and exit
  -d, --dir DIR         Directory to write plot pdf file (./pdf)
  -e, --end END         End time : absolute or relative days (all)
  -f, --file FILE       Input csv file (data)
  -o, --out OUT         Output PDF : if not specified will be based on input filename
```

(continues on next page)

(continued from previous page)

<code>-s, --start START</code>	Start time : absolute or relative days (all)
<code>-sh, --show</code>	Show plot in terminal (False)

APPENDIX

2.1 Installation

Available on * [Github](#) * [Archlinux AUR](#)

On Arch you can build using the provided PKGBUILD in the packaging directory or from the AUR. All git tags are signed with arch@sapience.com key which is available via WKD or download from <https://www.sapience.com/tech>. Add the key to your package builder gpg keyring. The key is included in the Arch package and the source= line with *?signed* at the end can be used to verify the git tag. You can also manually verify the signature

```
git tag -v <tag-name>
```

To build manually, clone the repo and :

```
rm -f dist/*  
/usr/bin/python -m build --wheel --no-isolation  
root_dest="/" root_dest  
./scripts/do-install root_dest
```

When running as non-root then set root_dest a user writable directory

2.2 Dependencies

Run Time :

- python (3.13 or later)
- python-pandas
- python-matplotlib
- pyconcurrent

Building Package :

- git
- hatch (aka python-hatch)
- wheel (aka python-wheel)
- build (aka python-build)
- installer (aka python-installer)
- rsync

Optional for building docs :

- sphinx
- texlive-latexextra (archlinux packaguing of texlive tools)

2.3 Philosophy

We follow the *live at head commit* philosophy as recommended by Google's Abseil team¹. This means we recommend using the latest commit on git master branch.

2.4 License

Created by Gene C. and licensed under the terms of the MIT license.

- SPDX-License-Identifier: MIT
- SPDX-FileCopyrightText: © 2025-present Gene C <arch@sapience.com>

¹ <https://abseil.io/about/philosophy#upgrade-support>

LICENSE

Netcheck software license.

Copyright © 2025-present Gene C <arch@sapience.com>

This program is free software; you can redistribute it and/or modify it under the terms of the GNU General Public License as published by the Free Software Foundation; either version 2 of the License, or (at your option) any later version.

This program is distributed in the hope that it will be useful, but WITHOUT ANY WARRANTY; without even the implied warranty of MERCHANTABILITY or FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE. See the GNU General Public License for more details.

You should have received a copy of the GNU General Public License along with this program; if not, write to the Free Software Foundation, 51 Franklin Street, Fifth Floor, Boston, MA 02110-1301, USA.